Responsible Administrator: Provost
Responsible Office: Office of Military & Veteran Success
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Approved by: Academic Affairs Council
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Uniformed Service Mobilization Policy

Purpose of Policy

The Louisiana public higher education community recognizes that many of its students serve our country in the active duty and reserve forces of the U.S. Armed Services and in the Louisiana National Guard, and that these students are subject to unforeseen mobilization/activation for training in response to local, regional, national, or international emergency situations. Obviously, such emergency mobilization/activation for training will seriously disrupt these students' academic careers. It is the policy of Louisiana public higher education to minimize the effects of this disruption as much as possible.

In order to qualify under the provisions of this policy, students must present to the registrar a copy of official military orders indicating their mobilization or activation for training. Students should contact the Office of Military and Veteran Success as soon as they are notified of activation. The Office of Military and Veteran Success will inform them of the procedures to be followed. If, due to time constraints between the time of notification and the time of actual mobilization or activation, the students cannot present their orders as required, the parents, guardians, or spouse of the student may do so.

Policy Procedure

1. **Awarding of Academic Credit / Grades**
    a. **Withdrawal options.** Students in the uniformed services who are mobilized/activated for training for a period of more than 30 days during a semester or term will be given the option of either: (1) complete withdrawal from the university for the semester; or (2) withdrawal from or continuation in individual courses within the university upon a determination that institution guidelines are met and that it is educationally sound to allow such continuation. Students who choose to remain enrolled in some or all courses should be provided reasonable support to ensure that the pursuit of education is disrupted to the minimum extent possible and that no undue penalties are assessed due to a military call to service.
    b. **Course Withdrawals.** When mobilization/activation occurs prior to the university census date, mobilized students who withdraw will incur no penalty or grade in any course. Those who withdraw from all courses will be given a complete withdrawal from the university (with 100 percent refund of tuition and fees which have been paid, including student insurance and other non-refundable fees). After the census date, mobilized students who withdraw from a course shall receive a grade of “W” in the course and 100 percent refund of course-related tuition and fees which have been paid, excluding student insurance fees and other non-refundable fees. The student’s transcript will be annotated to reflect that the resignation is the result of activation for military duty. Housing and meal plan payments will be refunded on a prorated basis based on usage, regardless of the date of involuntary mobilization/activation.
    c. **Continued Enrollment After Involuntary Mobilization/Activation.** Students may choose to remain enrolled in individual courses upon a determination that it is educationally sound to allow such

continuation and with the concurrence of the instructor and/or dean, as required by university guidelines. For courses in which enrollment is continued, the following should be documented by the instructor and/or dean: (a) provisions for a grade of incomplete; (b) provisions for a final grade based upon course work prior to the date of mobilization; or (c) an early final examination in order that the instructor can determine a final course grade. Those students who receive incomplete grades shall have no longer than one year after the conclusion of the involuntary term of active duty to meet with the instructor and/or dean and work out a timetable for removing the incomplete grades.

2. **Notice of Intent to return.** Notice of intent to return must be provided not later than three years after the completion of the period of service. For a servicemember who is hospitalized for or convalescing from an illness or injury incurred in, or aggravated during, the performance of service, notice must be provided not later than two years after the end of the period that is necessary for recovery from such illness or injury. It may be oral or written and must be provided to the Registrar's Office. In addition to providing notice, the servicemember must provide documentation to establish that–
    a. He or she has not exceeded the cumulative five-year limit on absences from the institution; and
    b. His or her eligibility for readmission has not been terminated (see Q&A21).
    c. A servicemember who fails to provide notice of intent to return within the applicable time period does not automatically forfeit eligibility for readmission to an institution, but is subject to the institution's established leave of absence policy and general practices. The types of documents necessary will vary from case to case. Not all of these documents are available or necessary in every instance. An institution may not delay or attempt to avoid readmission of a servicemember by demanding documentation that does not exist, or is not readily available, at the time of readmission.
    d. Documents that may be used for this purpose include:
        i. DD (Department of Defense) 214 Certificate of Release or Discharge from Active Duty.
        ii. Copy of duty orders prepared by the facility where the orders were fulfilled carrying an endorsement indicating completion of the described service.
        iii. Letter from the commanding officer of a Personnel Support Activity or someone of comparable authority.
        iv. Certificate of completion from military training school.
        v. Discharge certificate showing character of service.
        vi. Copy of extracts from payroll documents showing periods of service.
        vii. Letter from National Disaster Medical System (NDMS) Team Leader or Administrative Officer verifying dates and times of NDMS training or Federal activation.

3. **Academic Status Upon Re-Enrollment**. When students whose enrollment was interrupted by mobilization/activation re-enroll within five years of completion of their involuntary term of active service, the university will make every possible effort to place the students back into their academic studies track as close as possible to the same place they occupied when mobilized/activated. The normal readmission application fee will be waived for these students.
    a. The readmission requirements apply to servicemembers who perform service in the uniformed services, whether voluntary or involuntary, in the Armed Forces, including service as a member of the National Guard or Reserve, on active duty, active duty for training, or full-time National Guard duty under Federal authority (but not State authority), for a period of more than 30 consecutive days under a call or order to active duty of more than 30 consecutive days.
    b. Reasonable attempts will be made to give preferential enrollment into high demand courses necessary for these students to continue their studies with as little interruption as possible.

c. Time spent on active duty may not be counted in determining the catalogue under which the student must meet curricular or degree requirements; involuntary mobilization/activation will not be considered a break in continuous attendance, for catalogue purposes. A person who, upon being offered separation from involuntary active duty, reenlists or otherwise voluntarily extends active duty, may be considered to have broken continuous attendance.
d. In instances of substantial change to curricula or course inventory during the period of involuntary military service, the institution may make reasonable accommodations with substitute courses, independent study or other appropriate means. If a student's curriculum no longer exists at the time of re-enrollment, the institution shall reasonably assist the student in changing to a new curriculum or transferring to an institution where the desired curriculum is available.
e. A servicemember's eligibility for readmission terminates upon the occurrence of:
    i. A dishonorable or bad conduct discharge.
    ii. A dismissal of a commissioned officer permitted under section 1161(a) of Title 10 U.S.C. by sentence of a general court martial, in commutation of a sentence of a general court-martial, or, in time of war, by order of the President.
    iii. A dropping of a commissioned officer from the rolls pursuant to section 1161(b), Title 10 U.S.C. due to absence without authority for at least three months, separation by reason of a sentence to confinement adjudged by a court-martial, or a sentence to confinement in a Federal or State penitentiary or correctional institution.

4. **Cost to Attend.** For the **first academic year**, with the same tuition and fee charges as when the servicemember left, unless military benefits will pay the increase, but never more than the institution is charging other students. For subsequent academic years or for a different program, by assessing tuition and fee charges that are no more than the institution is charging other students.

5. **Scholarships.** A student who is mobilized/activated while holding a scholarship under the control of the university shall have the scholarship, or an equivalent scholarship, reinstated upon re-enrolling at the university after the period of involuntary active duty so long as he/she remains otherwise eligible. This provision shall lapse if the student does not re-enroll in the university within one year from the time of separation from the involuntary active duty.

6. **Books.** All rental textbooks should be returned prior to leaving campus unless the student remains enrolled in courses.

7. **Student Grants and Loans.** Students who have been awarded grants or loans and are mobilized/activated at any time during the semester are advised to consult with the Office of Financial Aid in order to obtain clarification and/or further information on the status or repayment requirements of any existing grants and loans for attending the university.

Reference

Louisiana Board of Regents Academic Affairs Policy 2.21, Uniformed Service Mobilization: https://regents.la.gov/assets/docs/PRAA/Academic_Affairs/AA.-2-21-2013-0815.pdf.

OPE Policy Initiatives: FAQ on Readmission of Servicemembers to Institutions of Higher Education https://www.ed.gov/higher-education/veterans-and-military-families/ope-policy-initiatives-faq-on-readmission-of-servicemembers-to-institutions-of-higher-education

[End of Policy]